



Objection Rebuttal Book

“Are you on the list/an approved vendor?”

- “I figured a company of your stature and reputation might have a preferred vendors list. The purpose of my goal is to gain a deeper understanding of the process for how your current vendors got on that list. What are the specific steps and approvals that take place in order to add a vendor?”
- “Mr. customer, this probably is not the case with you, but many of our customers who also have a vendors list share with us that they get 80% of the results from just 20% of their vendors. What are you seeing?”/“How are you dealing with your under performing vendors?”
- If an MSP, when are the next QBR’s scheduled? When will you be reviewing vendors again? Do you ever engage niche partners for hard to fill roles?
- “Not as of yet but I was hoping you could help me with that or point me in the right direction. I’ve placed consultants at XYZ Company, who does similar work as your company. Can I tell you more about who we placed?”
- “We are one of the top vendors in the technology field, usually we get added due to our reputation or the Program office would recommend a pass through minority entity to assist bringing someone on”
- “I understand and that’s not why I am calling, I noticed on your website that you are looking for (one of MMI niches) and we have talent pools in this/these skillsets.”
- “Are you asking about our vendor status because you have current opening that is challenging to fill?”
- “To be honest, I am not interested in going through a month-long process with legal. We have a pass-through company that is already approved, I am happy to pay the \$4 bucks an hour to onboard. It allows me to get you people onboarded smoothly in your week to 10 days process.”
- “No we are not. The reason for my call is to discuss how MM can fill the gap in the areas your current vendors are not delivering. We hear from client’s biggest frustration is their current vendors are not able to deliver in current market conditions.”

“We don’t use staffing agencies...”

- “Wouldn’t it be beneficial to know about the best candidates in the market, even if you chose to use your own internal hiring resources? You can use our service to benchmark the talent that you are seeing on your own.”
- “How do you typically go about bringing on talent to the organization? How long is it taking on average to fill your open positions?”
- “I understand. However, can I ask how you hire when you do have an open position?”
- “In my experience, managers lose their openings if not filled in a certain time, If I was to find you the perfect candidate would HR really stop you and not assist?”
- “How do you find solid IT candidates in a tough market? Have you ever considered it? Are you aware of the benefits?”
- I understand, the purpose of my call today is not to sell you on using agencies. It is to introduce myself in case the days comes where you need to use an agency. If someone on your team was to resign tomorrow would you be prepared to fill the position with your current HR staff or network?

“We have an MSP/VMS that runs the program”

- “MMI often partners with other firms when we are not part of the MSP program. If we identify a resource for you, we will partner with a preferred vendor to get them onboard. (can use this for number 1 as well)”
- “I figured you might – most of our clients the size of XYZ company do. What MSP are you using? We have strong relationships with all the major MSP’s – Pontoon, Allegis, ProUnlimited, etc. Which program manager do you work with most frequently?”
- “Got it, understood. I know some managers prefer to work directly with staffing companies vs. through the MSP. Does that describe you? Would you be open to making an introduction to the persons name that manages the MSP?”
- “We are one of the top MSP partners in the country. Over 100 of our clients use these programs and most of them know us. Can you introduce me to them, or tell me which company so, we can approach them from their side? What tool is it? Fieldglass? Beeline? Do you have a role that has not a single decent candidate? 90% of the time. Someone in the program office would assist you if I found you what you needed.”
- “I understand and we are part of the program (if we are). We work with the program but also find the most success when dealing decision makers directly.”
- 50% of our business is currently within the VMS world. We understand that model and are successful at filling those positions.

“HR does all of our hiring”

- “How has that been working?” If not so well try to push a Niche or a solid candidate that fits an opening that you found on the company website.
- “I understand and am happy to work with them, but I’d love to get to know you and the needs you may have upcoming. Ultimately, you are the one who makes the hiring decisions, correct?”
- “In my experience when we find a manager the perfect candidate, HR is happy to help facilitate a hire. Can you introduce me or at least see if I can prove our capabilities to you first?”
- “Ok. In my experience, HR typically leads hiring for full time, permanent employees. Do you ever have the need to hire contractors for project work? If so, do you manage that hiring yourself?”
- “Gotcha, we work alongside a lot of HR and Talent Acquisition teams. What has been your experience working with them? Have you ever worked with an Agency alongside HR previously?”
- “I can appreciate that HR does all of your hiring, with that said, is there a specific need that you have that I can reference to HR when I reach out? Who can I speak to with in your HR department? So that I don’t waist their time, can you tell me some of the must haves for the opportunity so I am better prepared to speak to HR and begin the search?”

“We don’t want to pay your fees/Your price is too high”

- “I can appreciate that you are cost conscious, however, we are a contingent firm which means that you only pay us a fee if you hire one of our candidates.” You can use our candidates as a comparison to the ones that you are finding on your to ensure that you are truly evaluating the best candidates on the market.
- “Appreciate where you’re coming from, I’ve sat in your shoes and have managed a P&L including the vendor spend and agency budget – I can appreciate how the fees can add up. Because I’ve sat in that seat before, I also know how expensive it is to have a position go unfilled (exhausting your HM’s, anyone involved in the interview process and the stress it takes on the remaining workers that begin getting burned out covering for an open role – it can lead to attrition which of course means more open roles). The quality of service and the access to a passive candidate pipeline that is carefully cultivated and nurtured to allow us to respond to our clients with top talent in 48-72 hours on average is what you’re paying for. We’ll also manage the entire lifecycle of fully vetting every candidate, taking them through the interview process and handling their expectations and yours as we progress. We give you market rate analysis, candidate feedback – to name a few. If the role is a priority, it’s really saving money in the grand scheme.”
- “I understand and want to be sensitive to your budget. The good news is that you owe no fees to Mitchell Martin until you decide to hire. We don’t work off of retainers. You pay our fee when/if you hire our candidate. And, to further make sure you’re satisfied, we commit to a 90 day guarantee that would allow for us to find a replacement if our candidate is not meeting expectations and/or a return of the fee you paid.”
- “We are flexible. We would rather charge a good client less and be productive than charge an indifferent client more. I would have to speak to my leadership, but what did you have in mind? For exclusivity we regularly drop our fees by a few points.”
- “It costs you nothing to look at the candidates I provide. Only if/ when you select them.”
- “I understand, how long have you been trying to fill this role? Who is covering this role while you are trying to fill the role and is that causing them to have an excessive workload? This type of role is in our wheel house and I could have candidate resumes over to you in the next 24 hours.”
- “Mr. customer we provide the consultant rate and the margin so you can see the value. And, we will share with you High, medium and low years of experience, so you can see a cross-section of talent level.”
- Unfortunately our fees and price are driven by market conditions. I agree with you rates are high but that is a result of supply and demand and candidate are receiving calls for higher rates daily. I hope they come back down to reality one of these days as well. It is very frustrating.

“Why you/why your firm if you are all finding the same candidates?”

- “Not all firms have the same candidates. We will be able to provide you passive job seekers who are working exclusively through MMI. You won’t be able to find these resources through other vendors. The reason you work with my firm is because of our track record of servicing clients in your industry. I would be happy to provide client testimonials that demonstrate our success.”
- “Fair question! Our recruiting organization is broken out into a number of niche specialization recruiting centers, so instead of having generalists working on your niche positions (reinventing the wheel every time), we have experts in the tech verticals (list niches here) that understand the nuances of not only the tech, but what the passive candidates want in an employer. We don’t just wait for candidates to apply to roles, we proactively engage them, carefully cultivate our passive candidate network and remain in constant contact with them, which ultimately gives you access to candidates that you otherwise wouldn’t have access to.”
- “I get the perception that we’re all chasing the same candidates. However, we’ve taken an approach that sets us apart from competition (Talent Pools, Niche Recruiting Teams, etc.)”
- “I don’t believe that is the case. We are one of the few firms in the country that spends many thousands a year per person for LinkedIn’s most expensive licenses. ALL of our close to 100 recruiters have them. Furthermore we have an exceptional research arm. If that wasn’t enough we also have been around for 35 years and while we clean our database up every ten years, we have millions of candidates in just our system alone that we have worked with/interviewed or placed before.”
- “Great question, first of all you will be working with me and I am supported by 170 plus recruiters both on shore and offshore that support me. I can provide you X number of references if you’ like.”
- It is not that we find the same candidates. It is what we do with our recruiting process when we find those candidates. Do you have 2 minutes for me to explain what we do differently?

“I’ve had a bad experience with other vendors in the past”

- “I appreciate why you are apprehensive. Can I suggest we meet to discuss my background and MMI’s track record. Perhaps your past experience was more about the individuals you worked with vs the firm itself.”
- “Unfortunately that does happen in this industry and it can lead to a bad taste for the good ones like me. What did you experience that turned you off?” (use the information gathered here to then sell how we’re different – if you don’t know what it was that was bad, you can’t respond with a solution that will resonate)
- “What made the experience bad? To me, staffing is more about service to our clients than it is about finding the perfect candidate. In fact, I think that’s impossible. As the representative of Mitchell Martin, I need to respond to your needs, whether it’s a positive or negative experience.”
- “I promise you. That will not happen with us. What’s your hardest job or biggest pain point? You can look at our glassdoor reviews. It’s a shame that some firms out there give us good firms a bad name. would hope we wouldn’t be lumped in with those types of firms.”
- “Oh really, what exactly did they do? You tell me more about that.”
- “I’m sorry to hear that, unfortunately I get that response a lot. Can you tell me what happened? I am happy to share with some things my clients say about their experiences working with MMI.”

“I’m happy with my current vendors”

- “I can appreciate how you feel as many of our other clients have felt the same way, but what they found was that it costs nothing to compare my candidates to the ones they are seeing through their current vendors. This way you can ensure you are evaluating the best candidates on the market. ”
- “Glad to hear you’re happy. How’s it going with those vendors?” (see if there are any pain points – keep asking questions – what is their typical time to fill? Do they show great candidates to you in 48 hours? Etc.)
- “I understand. That said, is there any gap with your current vendors relative to filling niche positions?”
- “Many managers are, but I bet if you have a tough job you’re not getting enough attention on , you would be happy with us too.”
- “It cost you nothing to look at my candidates as compared to the competitions. How long and What do they do that you like? Who doesn’t like a competition? Let me show you what I can do. We are good too.”
- Find a role on the clients website that fits our niche and push to go in that way.

“We are currently only working with diverse suppliers”

- “MMI actually has a sister company called Dale Workforce Solutions. We often partner with DWS as they are a diversity supplier.
- “That’s great to hear, a lot of my clients are putting an emphasis on diversity in their vendor relationships. We actually have a partnership with a diversity supplier that we’re able to work through called Dale Workforce – we’ve utilized this partnership with a lot of success in the past. Are you open to learning more about Dale?”
- “Diversity is very important in today’s workplace. The good news is that Mitchell Martin has a sister company, Dale Workforce, that is a majority Women Owned business. Would you like to learn more and/or talk with my colleagues at Dale Workforce?”
- “We work closely with our former President who started her own WMBE firm with us providing the infrastructure. She is a wonderful collaborator and has over 2 decades of experience. Can I introduce her to you?”
- “I hear this a lot, can I share with that we have a diversity partner DWS and I would be happy to make introductions. Can I tell you more about DWS and our relationship?”

“I’m so busy, I don’t have time to talk or meet”

- “I understand how you feel as I am busy as well. By meeting/talking with me now, it will actually help you move faster the next time you have a hiring need.”
- “I hear ya, I know sometimes it feels like I’m drinking from a fire hose myself. I know you have a ton of demand on your time, but I’m actually hoping to be able to give you back quite a bit of it by reducing your time to fill critical positions by 50-75%. Do you think we can squeeze in now 15-15 minutes later this week to see if we’d be a good partner? I have my calendar up in if you have a preference on day/time?”
- “I can appreciate that and don’t want to interrupt the flow of your day. I find that early mornings (8:00), the lunch hour, and late day (5:30) are good times to have a quick intro call. Could I steal 10 minutes of your time during those windows?”
- “We all are. I totally get it. Can we schedule something say a few weeks out? We now work hard to limit our meeting to 15 minutes.”
- “No problem, could I try you later today or tomorrow? When would be a good time, I wanted to see if you could help me.” Name drop, intro yourself, we are approved vendor, we have an MSA in place, we are an IT staffing vendor.
- “Man I get it everything is a bit crazy these days, I’m going to be in your area (Pick the time) I’ll only ask for 20 minutes and I’ll bring the coffee.”
- “I am not interested in selling you just delivering. I literally spend 4 mins a month with my clients. I just want you to know that if you are at your desk, and something of need comes across your laptop, if you send it to me its covered. I will give you (2) spot-on consultants in less than 8 hours. If its full-time its 2 days. No one today wants another buddy. My team supports 50+ clients; we just deliver one at a time.”

“Just send me an email/some information”

- “So I don’t waste your time, can you please tell me what information you specially would like to see? Let’s schedule a follow up appointment and I will send some info ahead of time so that we can have a more in dept conversation. ”
- “Happy to, is your email address XYZ? What specific information would interest you?” If they say “anything”, “John, so I don’t do you a disservice and send you information that’s not relevant, “would you be against continuing the conversation over the next week or two so I can better tailor the information? It’s perfectly okay if this isn’t a priority. I know you have multiple forces competing for your attention.” // if they give more time “Just so we’re not playing phone tag, would it make sense to get something on the calendar”
- “Are you genuinely interested in learning more about MMI/FortyOak or is this a polite way to get me off the phone?” (has to be delivered in the right way)
- “I can certainly do that. I’ll send information over right after this call. While the information is detailed, there’s much more I’d like to hear about you and what’s going on at ABC Company. Before I do, would it be possible to schedule 10 minutes on Friday to review the information that I’ll be sending?”
- “What separates us from the pack is that we strive to learn the intricate details of our clients environment, ill be happy to send you some info but a quick convo would help me customize it to YOUR needs.”
- “I certainly can do that, but I need to know what interests you and what is valuable to you. Can we talk further about that?”
- “I can certainly do that and will but its been my experience that building a relationship starts with a meeting. Is there anytime that you might be available over the next 2 to 3 weeks. I’ll only ask for 20 minutes.”

“I don’t have any needs right now”

- “When you say you don’t have any needs right now, is that because you recently filled an open position or perhaps there is a different point the quarter/year when you will likely having hiring needs?”
- “It’s rare that I talk to someone that’s fully staffed in this market – what a gift! Did you have to hire recently? (If so, how was that experience?) Do you have any upcoming initiatives the company is planning for this year? I usually find once the time comes, you have to move FAST, so it’s usually helpful to understand your org ahead of time so if you do have a need we can respond asap.”
- Understood. However, do you have projects slated to begin this year where you will need to hire? Also, do you know of any colleagues that might be hiring that I can speak with?
- Can we set up a TEAMS meeting so I can explain what we are best at, that way when you do have needs I would already have an understanding of your group. Is there anyone you work with that has any fires they need help putting out?
- “I want to further understand your org and business when you do have a need. When is a good time to call you back when you may have needs?”
- “Not a problem at all, I’m really looking to connect and learn more about you and what the balance of the year looks like for you and your team. That way when you are in a hiring mode MMI and I can support you.”

“Our budgets for this quarter haven’t been approved yet”

- “When you think your new budget will be approved? Do you anticipate that your new budget will allow for hiring in the next quarter or later in the year?”
- “We have quite a few clients that are just wrapping up their fiscal year and getting into budget planning/approvals for the upcoming as well! How are you planning for the upcoming year? Are there any major initiatives on the horizon or just BAU?”
- “Ok. What is the budgeting cycle at ABC Company? This will help me to know when is the right time to connect with you where our conversation can be most valuable.”
- “I have many clients that are interviewing now pending budgets. One of the things that separates us from our competitors is that our management feels we should be proactive and even if that means helping to fill a position not yet approved and the approval goes south, the learning curve (and more importantly the trust) is established for the future so it’s still in our minds a kind of a win? Don’t you think?”
- “No problem and very understandable given the time of year. When you do get your approved budget what type of talent do you typically look for? Once you have this information, talk about how we have talent pools in this/these skillsets and offer to send over a sample resume and set a follow up time to connect.”

